170. The NRC is a legacy of the Assam Accord of 1985 and the Assam movement that preceded it. A key demand of that movement against 'foreigners' was for 'detection, deletion and deportation' of illegal Bangladeshi migrants. It was a demand that was specifically coded into the Assam Accord signed by the Rajiv Gandhi-led Central government. The Assam government under Tarun Gogoi tried to start a project to update the 1951 NRC list with a pilot project in 2010 in Barpeta and Kamrup. It was put on the backburner after serious pushback. Things changed only after the Supreme Court mandated an updation exercise in 2013 after a writ petition filed by the Assam Public Works. The exercise began in early 2015, and the court has been constantly monitoring the exercise since then. It has reportedly cost over Rs 1,220 crore, engaged 40,000 government employees, 8,200 contractual employees and took over five years. Nalin Mehta, 'NRC's political googly', *The Times of India*, 10 September 2019.

171. Literally 'sons of the soil', a term used by several tribal indigenous communities to denote themselves in the state

172. 'Bodo accord will bring progress and prosperity for the community and Assam: PM'. Full text of his speech in Kokrajhar on 7 February 2020 available at: https://www.narendramodi.in/text-of-prime-minister-narendra-modi-s-address-at-kokrajhar-in-assam-548326.

173. Full text of Assam Accord available at: https://assam.gov.in/en/main/ASSAM%20ACCORD.

174. Special Correspondent, 'Assam Accord Clause 6: Panel submits report to chief minister', *The Hindu*, 25 February 2020, https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/other-states/assam-accord-clause-6-panel-submits-report-to-chief-minister/article30912307.ece.

175. Moonmoon Ghosh, 'Planning to Visit Meghalaya? Outsiders will now have to register with govt', News18.com, 2 November 2019, https://www.news18.com/news/india/planning-to-visit-meghalaya-outsiders-will-now-have-to-register-with-govt-as-cabinet-approves-new-rule-2370913.html.

176. Rahul Karmakar, 'Tripura, where demand for Assam-like NRC widens gap between indigenous people and non-tribal settlers',